

ID Hackathon 2026 Student Account Setup Guide

Builder Center ID AWS Kiro and Amazon Quick

Complete these steps before the online training on 11 September 2026. Each student will use their own accounts. Complete the setup in this order: AWS Builder Center ID and student verification, personal AWS account and budget alerts, Kiro Students, and Amazon Quick. Start at least one day early because AWS account activation can take up to 24 hours.

Item	Details
Complete by	Before the AWS AI Services Introduction session
Allow	About 60 minutes, plus any AWS activation delay
Have ready	Laptop, charger, phone, personal email, university email, and payment method
Need help	Take a screenshot without passwords or payment details and contact the event team

Completion checklist

Setup item	Completion test	Done
AWS Builder ID	Builder Center opens and student verification is submitted or completed	☐
Laptop	You can install applications and use a current web browser	☐
AWS account	AWS Console Home opens using your own account	☐
AWS security	Root MFA is enabled and you have a separate daily sign in	☐
AWS budget	Monthly budget alert emails are configured	☐
Kiro	Kiro launches and shows that you are signed in	☐
Amazon Quick	The Quick web app opens using your own account	☐

Keep the accounts separate. Your AWS account, Kiro account, and standalone Amazon Quick account are different identities. You may use the same email address, but one sign in does not automatically create the other accounts.

Step 1 AWS Builder Center ID and student verification

Start here using your university or institution email address. AWS Builder ID gives you access to Builder Center and Skill Builder. It is separate from the AWS account that you will create in Step 2.

- [Start with AWS Builder Center](#)
- [Student account and free benefits guide](#)

1. **Open AWS Builder Center** Use the Start with AWS Builder Center link above and choose Sign in or create an account.
2. **Create your AWS Builder ID** Use your university or institution email address. Create a strong password and verify the email code.
3. **Complete your Builder profile** Choose a public alias and add the required profile details. Do not place private information in the public profile.
4. **Open Student Rewards** Start the student verification flow from Builder Center.
5. **Complete SheerID verification** Enter your university information and upload proof of enrollment only when requested.
6. **Check the student benefit** Open AWS Skill Builder and Student Rewards and confirm that your verification or benefits appear.

Keep this sign in. Use the same AWS Builder ID for Builder Center, Skill Builder, and Kiro when that sign in option is available. Record the email address and sign in method in your password manager.

Builder ID does not create an AWS account. The personal AWS account in Step 2 is a separate account and may still require a supported payment method. Student rewards or AWS credits must be claimed separately.

Builder Center completion test

- ☐ You can sign in to AWS Builder Center.
- ☐ Your public alias and profile appear.
- ☐ Student verification is submitted or completed.
- ☐ You can open AWS Skill Builder using the same Builder ID.

Laptop preparation

- Use a Windows, macOS, or Linux laptop. A tablet is not enough for the hackathon.
- Confirm that you can install applications using an administrator password.
- Install system updates, restart the laptop, and use the latest Firefox, Chrome, Edge, or Safari.
- Keep at least 5 GB of free disk space.
- Install an authenticator app on your phone, such as Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, or Authy.
- Create a folder called ID-Hackathon-2026 for your code, notes, diagrams, and slides.

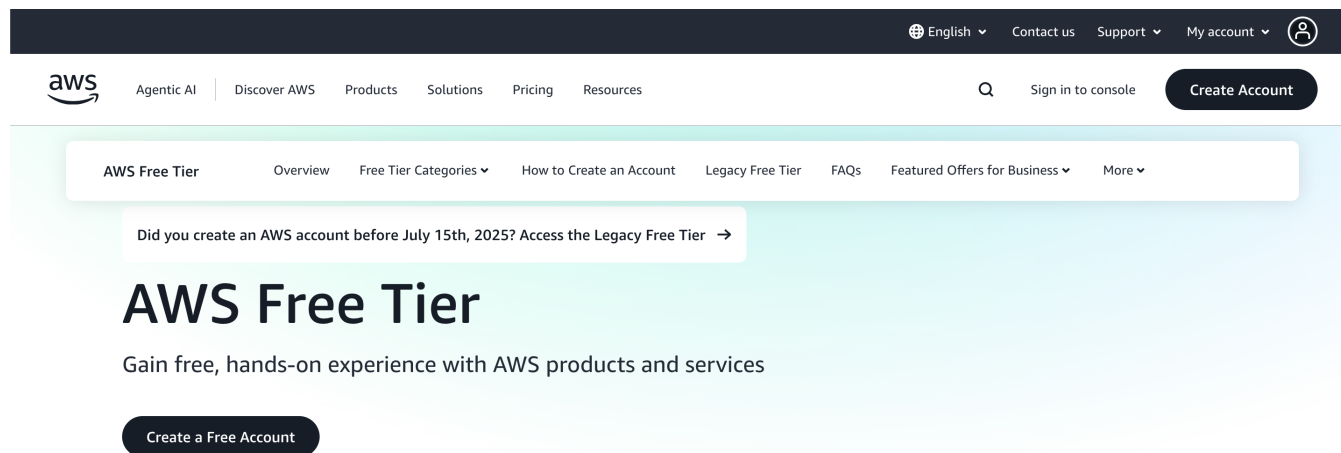
Step 2 Personal AWS account setup

Create one personal AWS account for the hackathon. Use an email address you control and expect to keep after graduation. AWS may request a payment method even when you choose the Free plan.

Before you start

- Personal email address for your AWS root user
- Phone for verification and multi factor authentication
- Accurate contact information
- Supported payment method if AWS requests one
- Password manager or another safe place to store a unique password

1. **Open AWS Free Tier** Go to the official AWS Free Tier page and choose Create a Free Account.
2. **Enter your email and account name** Use your personal email and a simple name such as firstname-student-hackathon.
3. **Verify your email** Enter the code sent by AWS and create a strong password that you do not use anywhere else.
4. **Enter contact and payment details** Use accurate information and complete any payment verification shown on the screen.
5. **Verify your phone** Enter the security code sent by text message or voice call.
6. **Choose the Free plan and basic support** Read the plan details shown during signup. Free Tier does not make every AWS service free. New accounts receive USD \$100 in AWS credits on signup, plus up to USD \$100 more by completing getting-started activities (up to USD \$200 total) — use these to stay within your budget.
7. **Wait for activation** AWS may take up to 24 hours. Continue only after AWS Console Home opens.



Official AWS Free Tier page. Benefits and eligibility can change.

Secure the AWS account

1. **Turn on root MFA** Sign in as the root user, open Security credentials, and add your authenticator app, passkey, or security key.
2. **Create a separate student administrator** In IAM, create a user named StudentAdmin, enable console access, add AdministratorAccess for this learning account, and enable MFA for the user.
3. **Sign out of root** Use StudentAdmin for the hackathon. Use the root user only for account, billing, or recovery tasks that require it.

4. Choose one AWS Region Use the Region announced during training and create all resources there unless the instructions say otherwise.

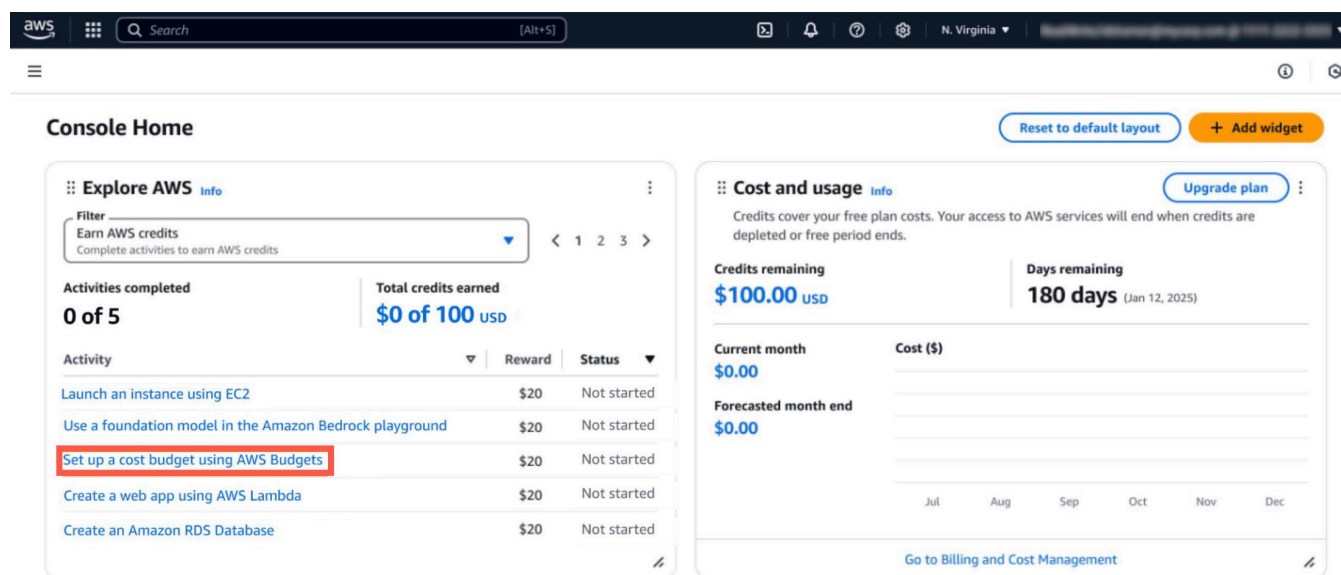
IAM Identity Center is not required for this setup. A personal Kiro account and a standalone Amazon Quick account can be created without IAM Identity Center. Do not create AWS Organizations for the hackathon.

Protect your account. Never share your root password, MFA codes, payment details, access keys, or secret keys. Never put these values in code, Kiro, Quick, Slack, screenshots, or a Git repository.

Step 2 AWS budget alerts

Create a budget before using AWS services. Use the hackathon budget stated by the event team. If no amount has been provided, choose a small limit that you can personally afford.

- 1. Open AWS Budgets** In the AWS Console, search for Billing and Cost Management, then choose Budgets.
- 2. Create a cost budget** Choose Create budget and select the monthly cost budget template or Customize.
- 3. Enter the amount** Name it IDHackathon-Monthly and enter the approved monthly amount.
- 4. Enter your email** Use an address that you check every day.
- 5. Add alerts** If Customize is available, add alerts at 50 percent, 80 percent, and 100 percent. Add a forecasted alert as well.
- 6. Create the budget** Review the amount and email address, then choose Create budget.



AWS Budgets setup screen. Current console labels may differ slightly.

Budget alerts are warnings, not hard stops. Billing data can be delayed and AWS resources continue running after an alert. Check spending every day and delete resources when you finish using them.

Simple ways to control cost

- Use one AWS Region.
- Create only the resources required for your project.
- Choose the smallest resource size that works.
- Stop or delete compute, databases, notebooks, endpoints, and other resources when you finish.
- Check Billing and Cost Management at the end of each day.

Step 3 Kiro student account setup

Kiro is the AI development environment used during the hackathon. Install it before training and create your own Kiro account.

- 1. Open the Kiro download page** Choose the installer for Windows, macOS, or Linux.
- 2. Install Kiro** Open the downloaded file, approve the installation, and launch Kiro.
- 3. Create or sign in to your Kiro account** Use a supported sign in option and use your university email when possible.
- 4. Open Account Usage** In Kiro, select the person icon in the lower left corner, then choose Account and Usage.
- 5. Start student verification** Find Kiro Students and choose Verify eligibility. Kiro opens the SheerID verification form.
- 6. Complete the SheerID form** Enter your university and student details. Upload proof of enrollment only if SheerID requests it.
- 7. Confirm the student benefit** Return to Account and Usage and check that the student benefit appears.
- 8. Run a simple test** Open the ID-Hackathon-2026 folder, create README.md, type one sentence, and save the file.

Kiro student benefit. Eligible students who are at least 18, attend an accredited college or university, and can verify enrollment may receive 1,000 Kiro credits each month for one year without a credit card. Verification through SheerID is usually instant, though it may occasionally ask you to upload proof of enrollment, so start a little early just in case.

Use the desktop application for this setup. Kiro Web and premium models are included once your student benefit is verified, but the desktop app is the simplest way to finish this pre-work. Students using a Chromebook or a locked computer should contact the event team before the training.

Protect your AWS account. Never paste an AWS password, MFA code, payment information, access key, or secret key into Kiro or your project files.

Create the first Kiro Spec

- 1. Open Kiro chat** Describe one small feature that you want to build.
- 2. Choose Spec** Use the Spec workflow for an important feature so Kiro creates a written plan before generating the implementation.
- 3. Review the requirements** Read requirements.md and correct anything that does not match your idea.
- 4. Review the design and tasks** Check design.md and tasks.md before asking Kiro to start implementation.
- 5. Save the Kiro project files** Kiro stores Specs under .kiro/specs and project guidance under .kiro/steering.

Keep useful Kiro files in version control. Kiro Specs and Steering files are designed to be shared with the project. Review the .kiro folder first, remove any private information, and never commit passwords, access keys, tokens, or confidential data.

AWS access from Kiro

- No AWS connection or Amazon Q Developer extension is required to complete this pre-work.
- Kiro can create and edit project files before it has access to your AWS account.
- If a later lab deploys to AWS, follow the event instructions for AWS CLI or a named AWS profile.
- Use StudentAdmin rather than the root user and prefer temporary credentials when the lab supports them.

- Never paste an access key or secret key into Kiro chat, configuration files, or source code.

Kiro completion test

- ☐ Kiro opens without an installation error.
- ☐ Your account name or sign in status is visible.
- ☐ Account and Usage shows the verified student benefit if you are eligible.
- ☐ The ID-Hackathon-2026 folder opens.
- ☐ You can create and save a README.md file.
- ☐ A test Spec contains requirements.md, design.md, and tasks.md.

Step 4 Amazon Quick account setup

Create a standalone Amazon Quick account in your browser. This account is separate from your AWS account and does not require IAM Identity Center.

- 1. Open the official Quick signup page** Go to <https://aws.com/quick> and choose Sign up for free.
- 2. Choose one sign in method** Continue with Google, Apple, or email and password. Use the same method every time.
- 3. Choose the Free plan** Review the plan shown on screen and avoid selecting a paid plan unless you intend to pay for it.
- 4. Verify your email** Open the verification message and complete the first-time account questions.
- 5. Open Quick in your browser** Confirm that the home page or chat screen loads.

No desktop installation is needed. Use the Quick web app unless the event team later asks you to install the desktop preview. Check your account plan after the hackathon and cancel any trial that you do not want to continue.

Use safe data. Do not upload passwords, access keys, private customer data, or confidential company information.

Quick completion test

- ☐ The Quick web app opens in a supported browser.
- ☐ You know which email and sign in method you used.
- ☐ The Free plan is visible in account settings.
- ☐ You can start a new conversation.

Free learning and student resources

The finalist briefing recommends these free resources. Sign up with your own email and use your university email when student verification is offered.

- [AWS Skill Builder courses](#)
- [Start with AWS Builder Center](#)
- [Everything AWS Gives Students for Free and How I Actually Used It](#)
- [AWS Builder Center student rewards](#)
- [Amazon Bedrock](#)
- [AWS Certification](#)
- Start with AWS Cloud Practitioner learning if you are new to cloud.
- Choose the AWS AI Practitioner path if you want to focus on generative AI and responsible AI.
- Use the Amazon Bedrock and agentic AI courses when you begin building the hackathon prototype.

- Student rewards, credits, vouchers, and eligibility can change. Check the current terms before relying on a reward.

Final readiness and cleanup

Check	Evidence to confirm	Done
Laptop	You can install applications and save files	☐
AWS activation	AWS Console Home opens	☐
AWS security	Root MFA is enabled and root is not used for daily work	☐
AWS Region	The training Region is selected	☐
AWS budget	A monthly alert is configured with your email	☐
Kiro	Kiro opens, README.md saves, and a test Spec is visible	☐
Amazon Quick	The web app opens on the Free plan	☐

After the hackathon

- ☐ Save your code, diagrams, prompts, demo files, and final presentation in the ID-Hackathon-2026 folder and an approved repository.
- ☐ Delete CloudFormation stacks first if you used them.
- ☐ Delete EC2 instances, databases, S3 buckets, notebooks, endpoints, APIs, load balancers, NAT gateways, and other project resources.
- ☐ Check every AWS Region because resources in another Region may be easy to miss.
- ☐ Remove access keys and secrets that you created for the project.
- ☐ Check Billing, Cost Explorer, and Budgets again over the next several days.
- ☐ Cancel any Kiro or Quick trial that you do not want to continue.

Deleting local files does not delete AWS resources. Confirm in the AWS Console that each resource has been deleted. Billing information can appear later, so check the account again after the event.

What not to do

- Do not share the AWS root password, MFA code, payment information, or access keys.
- Do not paste secrets into Kiro, Quick, source code, notebooks, screenshots, Slack, or Git repositories.
- Do not use the AWS root user for labs or everyday work.
- Do not create or join AWS Organizations for the hackathon.
- Do not launch paid or high-cost services unless the training requires them.
- Do not leave resources running overnight simply because a budget alert has not arrived.

Common setup problems

Problem	What to do
AWS activation email has not arrived	Check spam, confirm the email address, allow up to 24 hours, and contact AWS account support if needed
AWS phone or payment verification fails	Check the country, phone format, and billing details, then try another supported verification method

Problem	What to do
Kiro will not install	Confirm administrator rights, operating system support, free disk space, and restart the laptop
Kiro student verification is unavailable	Use your university email, confirm eligibility, and complete the verification flow
Quick opens the wrong account	Use the same sign in provider, sign out of other accounts, or use a private browser window
Budget alerts do not arrive immediately	Check the email and thresholds; billing data and notifications can be delayed

Official setup references

- [Create a standalone AWS account](#)
- [AWS Free Tier account plans](#)
- [Enable MFA for the AWS account root user](#)
- [Creating an AWS cost budget](#)
- [AWS account root user best practices](#)
- [Security best practices in IAM](#)
- [Kiro installation](#)
- [Kiro downloads](#)
- [Kiro Students](#)
- [Kiro Specs](#)
- [Kiro Steering](#)
- [Kiro Web](#)
- [Start with AWS Builder Center](#)
- [AWS student free benefits guide](#)
- [Amazon Quick standalone signup](#)
- [Amazon Quick standalone plans](#)

Documentation and the finalist briefing reviewed 10 September 2026. Product availability, Free Tier benefits, Kiro student eligibility, rewards, plans, and console labels can change. Use the linked official pages when completing setup.